

Interviewer: Thanks for joining. Let's start with a technical deep-dive ? tell me about a challenging project you've led recently.

Candidate: I owned the payments pipeline from design through launch this quarter.

Interviewer: Tell me about a time you owned a project from start to finish.

Candidate: We measured consumer lag and I decided to shed load at the edge first.

Interviewer: About "Built a Kafka pipeline handling about two million events per second": what decision did you make, and what would have broken it?

Candidate: I disagreed with the on-call rota and wrote the reason down for the team.

Interviewer: Tell me about a time you disagreed with a teammate and what you did.

Candidate: I pushed back in review and we agreed to split the change into two deploys.

Interviewer: About "Led a rollback of a production deploy during an incident": what decision did you make, and what would have broken it?

Candidate: I made the cutover call with incomplete traces and watched the error rate.

Interviewer: Tell me about a time you made a decision with incomplete information.

Candidate: I set a rollback threshold first, then let the migration run overnight.

Interviewer: Tell me about a time you missed the mark and what you changed afterward.

Candidate: I missed a rollback window and changed the release checklist the next day.

Interviewer: That's all the time we have. Thanks for walking me through your work ? you'll get a feedback report shortly.